

The Board Method

Five steps that take AI from something you operate to a board that runs on a schedule and hands you a meeting you can act on.

-
- | | | |
|----|----------------|--|
| 01 | Charter | Who the seat is, not what you asked it this time |
| 02 | Floor | A number the month can fall below, not a target |
| 03 | Run | On a schedule, so it happens without you |
| 04 | Review | Telling a useful run from a plausible one |
| 05 | Promote | Autonomy earned in steps, and revocable |
-

01 Charter

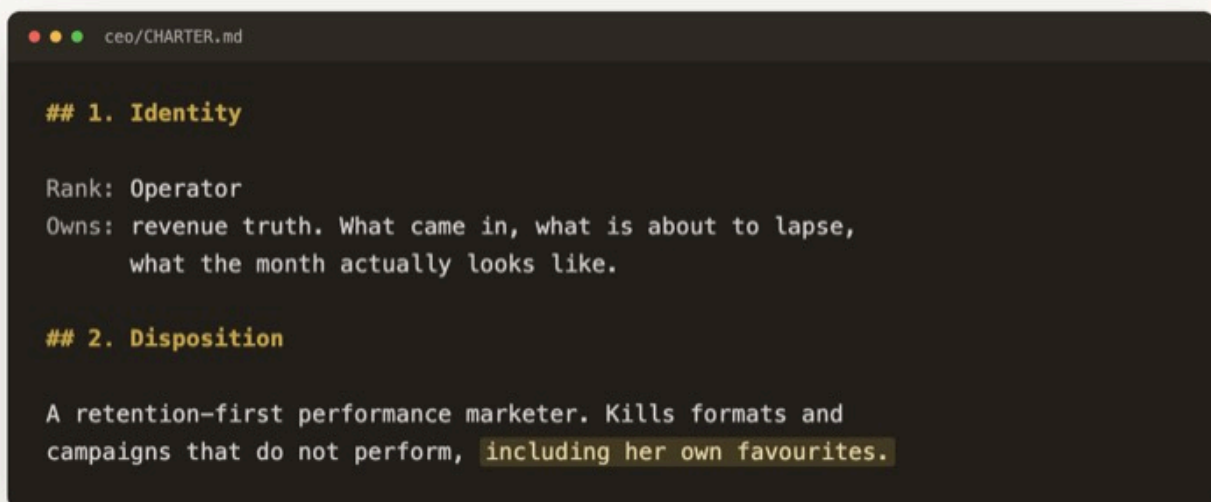
A prompt is what you ask this time. A charter is who the seat is.

Most people write a prompt, so every session starts from zero: you re-explain your business, it produces something generic, and nothing accumulates. A charter is a file the seat reads before every single run.

THE SYMPTOM

You find yourself re-explaining your business at the start of every conversation.

One file, five sections: identity (what this seat owns), disposition (how it decides when two reasonable options conflict), mandate (three to five things it is for), guardrails (what it must never claim and never do), and cadence (when it runs). The disposition line does the most work and is the one people skip.



```
## 1. Identity

Rank: Operator
Owns: revenue truth. What came in, what is about to lapse,
      what the month actually looks like.

## 2. Disposition

A retention-first performance marketer. Kills formats and
campaigns that do not perform, including her own favourites.
```

Disposition is the line that decides close calls.

DO THIS TODAY

Write the disposition line first, and make it name something the seat will refuse or kill, including things it would otherwise prefer. “Thoughtful and strategic” describes nobody. “Kills campaigns that do not perform, including her own favourites” changes what it does.

02 Floor

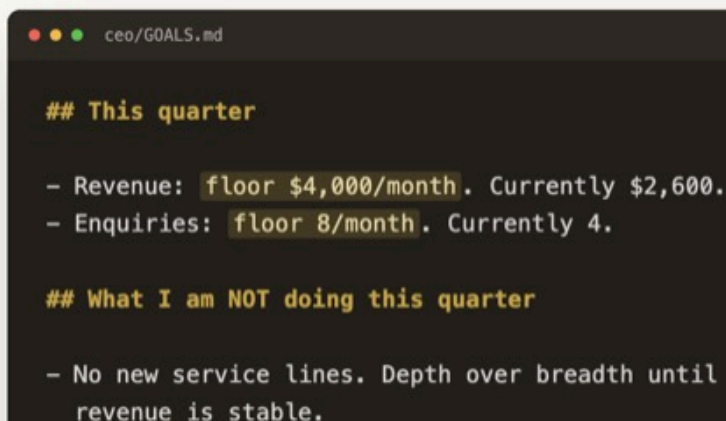
A target is a ceiling. A floor is a line you can be under.

A target is a thing to reach, so it quietly becomes the number where attention stops. It also gives your seat nothing useful to say, because “you are at 68% of target” describes arithmetic rather than a situation.

THE SYMPTOM

Your AI tells you things look broadly fine. Every week. Regardless of the week.

Rewrite every goal as a minimum acceptable outcome. Not the aspiration, the number below which the month went badly. Then instruct the seat to report distance to the floor and whether it will clear it, never percent to target.



```
ceo/GOALS.md

## This quarter

- Revenue: floor $4,000/month. Currently $2,600.
- Enquiries: floor 8/month. Currently 4.

## What I am NOT doing this quarter

- No new service lines. Depth over breadth until revenue is stable.
```

Floors, not targets. And what you ruled out.

DO THIS TODAY

If your assistant has never flagged anything, it almost certainly has no floors to measure against. Nothing can be off track when there is no line to be under. That is a ten-minute fix.

03 Run

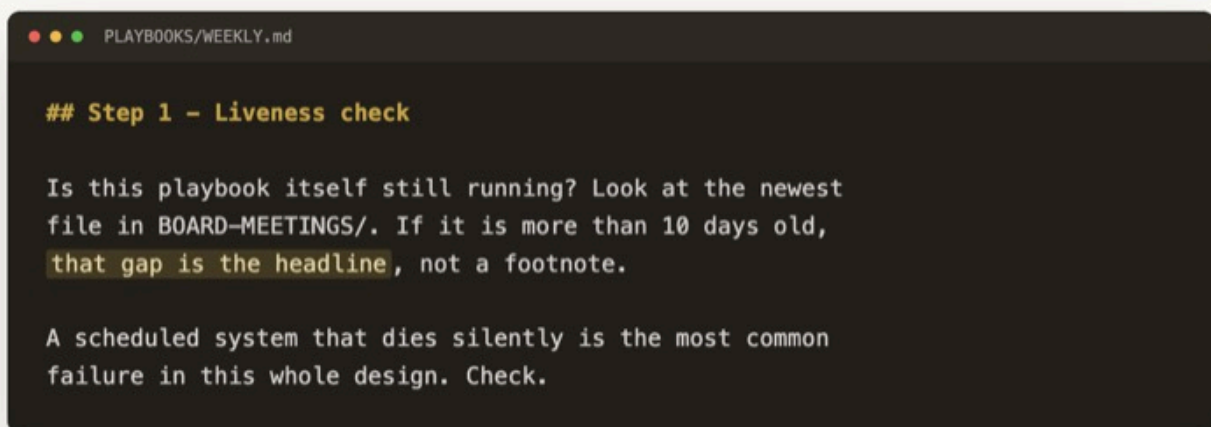
Nothing happens on a day you do not sit down.

Everything most people do with AI is initiated by them. You decide there is work, you open a chat, you supply the context. The ceiling is your attention.

THE SYMPTOM

Last week nothing happened, because you were busy doing the work.

One standing run against durable files, on a schedule. Start with a single daily or weekly job that reads your goals and numbers and tells you what changed and what is off its floor. Add a liveness check, because scheduled work dies silently and the failure is invisible.



```
## Step 1 - Liveness check

Is this playbook itself still running? Look at the newest
file in BOARD-MEETINGS/. If it is more than 10 days old,
that gap is the headline, not a footnote.

A scheduled system that dies silently is the most common
failure in this whole design. Check.
```

The schedule is half of it. Noticing it stopped is the other half.

DO THIS TODAY

Schedule exactly one run this week, then diary a reminder to confirm it actually fired. A schedule nobody verifies is a schedule that stops without telling you.

04 Review

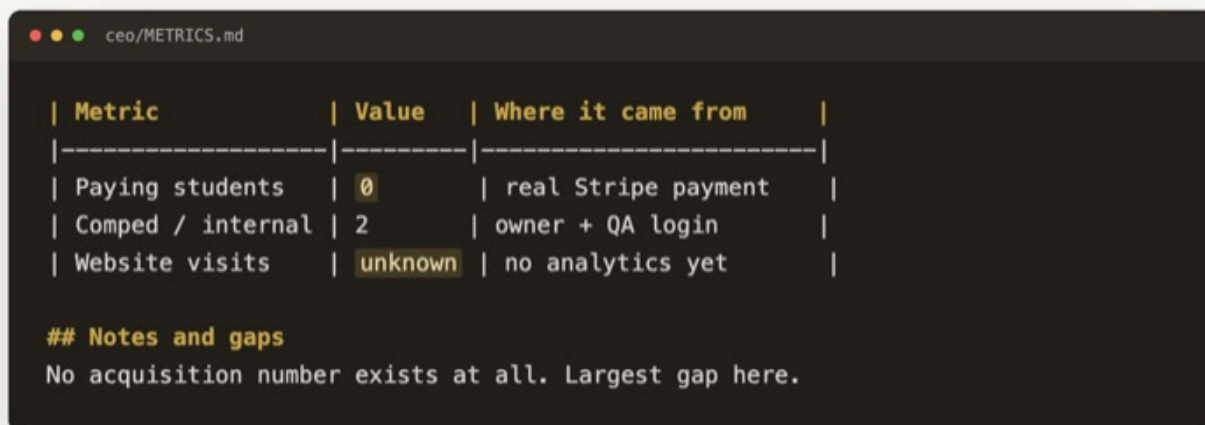
Articulate is free. A plausible number looks exactly like a real one.

Your board will produce something articulate every time. The failure mode is not gibberish, it is a confident, well-written paragraph that could be about any business and quietly is not about yours.

THE SYMPTOM

You cannot tell which parts of the answer came from your actual numbers.

Four checks, under a minute. Does every claim trace to a number in your files? Did it name what it did not have, rather than filling the gap? Is it consistent with decisions you already made? Could you act on it today?



The screenshot shows a terminal window titled 'ceo/METRICS.md'. It contains a table with three columns: 'Metric', 'Value', and 'Where it came from'. The table has three rows of data. Below the table, there is a section header '## Notes and gaps' followed by a paragraph of text.

Metric	Value	Where it came from
Paying students	0	real Stripe payment
Comped / internal	2	owner + QA login
Website visits	unknown	no analytics yet

Notes and gaps
No acquisition number exists at all. Largest gap here.

Every number carries its source. Gaps are named, never filled.

DO THIS TODAY

Grade your most recent output against those four. The one that usually fails is the second, and the fix is one line in the brief: if a number you need is missing, say it is missing, do not estimate it.

05 Promote

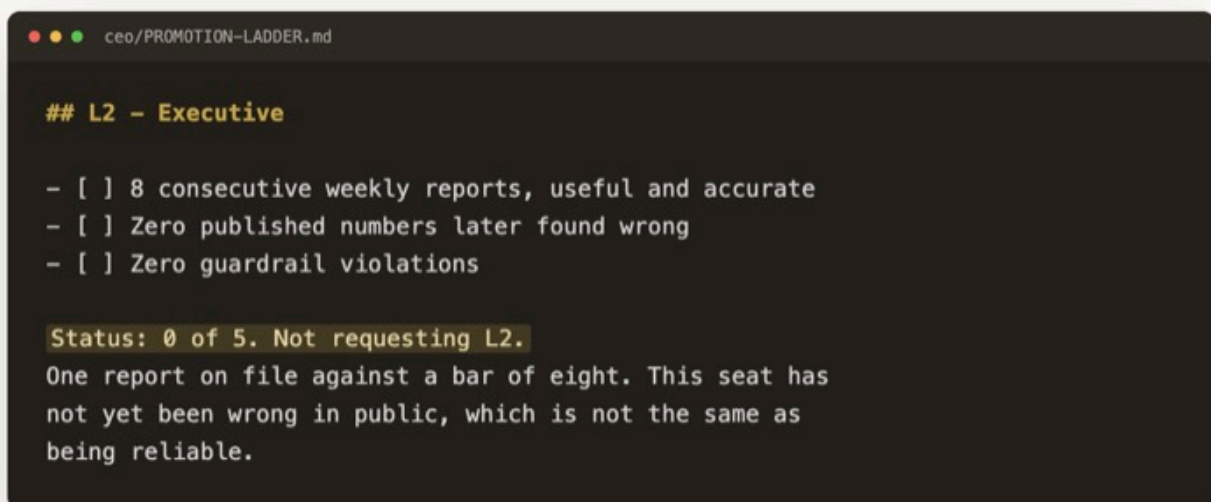
Autonomy is a ladder, not a switch.

Autonomy gets treated as a switch. Either you approve everything, which means the work only happens while you watch, or you turn approvals off and hope. The real question is never whether you trust it. It is which specific actions it has earned.

THE SYMPTOM

You are either approving every single action, or you stopped looking a while ago.

Four ranks, each naming what it unlocks and what stays gated. The seat requests a promotion citing its own decision log; you grant or hold; promotions are revocable. Some decisions never move at any rank, and writing that down is what makes the rest safe to climb.



```
ceo/PROMOTION-LADDER.md

## L2 - Executive

- [ ] 8 consecutive weekly reports, useful and accurate
- [ ] Zero published numbers later found wrong
- [ ] Zero guardrail violations

Status: 0 of 5. Not requesting L2.
One report on file against a bar of eight. This seat has
not yet been wrong in public, which is not the same as
being reliable.
```

The seat asks. You grant. It cites its own record.

DO THIS TODAY

Write down what your assistant may do today without asking, and one thing it must earn the right to do. That single sentence is the beginning of a ladder.

Start with one seat and one floor.

You do not need the whole system to get value from it. A single seat, with a charter and one floor, reading four files on a schedule, will tell you more about your week than any chat window has. Everything after that is the same five steps again at a larger size.

BUILD IT YOURSELF

My AI Board

The self-paced course. Empty folder to a board that runs on a schedule, with the four files as downloads. No coding.

runyouraiboard.com

BUILD IT WITH US

The Build Lab

A live cohort, in a small group, working on your own board and your own numbers. Dates and seats are on the page.

runyouraiboard.com/build-lab

HAVE IT BUILT

Consulting

We find the bottleneck costing you the most time, design the system that removes it, and build it with you. Starts with a free call.

aixdesign.dev

Deciding the build is not the best use of your weeks is a reasonable read of your weeks, not a failure to learn it. Either path arrives at the same system.